experienced the power of global finance to topple politicians and wreck economies, and its economic policymakers have ideas on how it might be better managed. Second, in Brazilian policymakers' conceptualization, BRICS financial statecraft dovetails with preexisting and normatively valued Brazilian preferences for nonconfrontation and what Brazilian diplomats refer to as "universalism." For Brazil, the BRICS club represents networking within the global South, an arena in which the nation can lead. Third, Brazilian policymakers anticipate some concrete benefits, primarily from closer economic and financial ties with China and Asia, although their expectations have been disappointed before, and so are not especially high.

Brazilian Attitudes Toward Global Financial Governance

Each of the BRICS has experienced or observed banking crises and international financial contagion in recent decades, but Brazilians are especially sensitive to the role of volatile capital markets in unseating political leaders and remaking (or threatening) national political or economic rules—as happened in Brazil in 1964, 1982, 1994, 1999, 2002, and 2007–2009.[229] For example, when former radical trade unionist da Silva won a plurality in the first round of presidential balloting in 2002, the resulting panic among both Brazilian and foreign investors precipitated a run on the currency, which dropped nearly 40 percent in two weeks. The rout was contained only after the candidate pledged in writing to continue his predecessor's moderately conservative macroeconomic policies—encouraging the IMF to extend an emergency credit to shore up the *real*.[230]

Brazil, like India, has a long and close history of interaction with the Washington, DC–based international financial institutions, including the World Bank, IMF, and Inter-American Development Bank, as well as regional development banks and think tanks, including the influential UN Economic Commission on Latin America and the Caribbean (ECLAC).[231] Familiarity sometimes has translated into informal influence, as when Brazilian economists in the 1980s lobbied for several years, ultimately successfully, to have the World Bank adopt Brazil's own definition of its public debt (which excluded interest payments and made the total debt smaller) rather than the bank's normal definition, as the standard for judging Brazilian compliance with loan conditionality. But such informal influence is by definition ad hoc and unpredictable. Brazilians are well